

State of Vermont

House of Representatives



Montpelier, Vermont

Concurrent House Resolution

H.C.R. 189

Offered by All Members of the House

Offered by All Members of the Senate

House concurrent resolution designating February 11, 2026, as Disability Advocacy Day at the State House

Whereas, the Vermont Coalition for Disability Rights (VCDR), founded in 1974, serves as a statewide coalition of disability rights organizations working to protect and advance people with disabilities, and

Whereas, the federal Americans with Disabilities Act, Pub. L. No. 101–336 (1990) (ADA), as amended, established comprehensive civil rights protections for persons with disabilities, and

Whereas, in *Olmstead v. L.C.*, 527 U.S. 581 (1999), the U.S. Supreme Court affirmed that unnecessary institutionalization of people with disabilities constitutes discrimination under the ADA, and

Whereas, the closure of the Brandon Training School in 1993 marked a historic moment in Vermont's disability rights progress, ending the State's operation of institutional facilities for persons with disabilities, and

Whereas, in Vermont, the prevalence of persons with disabilities is increasing, and they now represent one in four Vermonters, and

Whereas, recent State data shows that academic achievement and high school graduation rates for persons with disabilities and for students studying under an Individual Education Program are lower compared to the overall rates for the student population, and these education disparities have long-term life implications, and

Whereas, persons with disabilities continue to face barriers in accessing voting, securing employment, finding housing, and arranging for transportation, and are more likely to contemplate suicide, and

Whereas, despite these challenges, persons with disabilities make impressive and praiseworthy societal contributions in Vermont, and

Whereas, Disability Advocacy Day has occurred at the State House for many years and provides an important opportunity to recognize progress while acknowledging ongoing challenges, *now therefore be it*

Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives:

That the General Assembly designates February 11, 2026, as Disability Advocacy Day at the State House, *and be it further*

Resolved: That the Secretary of State be directed to send a copy of this resolution to VCDR.